

COMPETITIVE BATTLECARD

greytHR **vs** Keka

Your field guide to winning deals when Keka is in the room

30,000+

customers globally

3M+

employees on platform

25+

countries covered

Free

Starter tier available

Two different philosophies — same market

greytHR

Born payroll-first

FOUNDED 1994 / 2009

BY Greytip Software

PLATFORM DNA Compliance, accuracy, depth at SMB scale

"The platform that payroll managers trust."

VS

Keka

Born design-first

FOUNDED 2015

BY Keka Technologies

PLATFORM DNA Modern UX, fast onboarding, employee-centric design

"The platform that HR managers love to demo."

Lead with this when Keka comes up

"Keka looks polished in demos. But when payroll hits an error at 9 PM on a Friday and support is offline — what does modern actually cost you? greytHR brings 25+ years of statutory depth, a free Starter tier, and 30,000+ customers who chose reliability over aesthetics."

● Statutory depth

PF, ESI, TDS, PT, LWF auto-updated when regulations change — no dev tickets, no release cycle wait.

● Multi-country reach

Live in UAE, KSA, Kuwait, Oman, Bahrain, Qatar, Singapore. Keka is India-primary.

● Transparent pricing

Free Starter up to 25 employees. Modular — you pay for what you use, not a bundle.

● Support you trust at crunch time

No Friday night blackout. greytHR support is available when payroll closes.

Where greytHR wins, holds, and trails

FEATURE	greytHR	Keka	KEY DISTINCTION
Indian statutory compliance (PF, ESI, TDS, PT, LWF)	●●●	●●○	greytHR auto-updates; Keka needs dev tickets
Multi-country / GCC payroll	●●●	●○○	greytHR live in 7 GCC markets; Keka India-primary
Payroll accuracy	●●●	●●○	Both solid; greytHR has deeper SMB statutory muscle
Modern UI / design	●●○	●●●	Keka wins aesthetics; greytHR is functional, improving
Employee self-service (ESS)	●●●	●●●	greytHR deeper on desktop; Keka smoother on mobile
Biometric / field attendance	●●●	●●○	Keka geofencing glitches; greytHR biometric is robust
Performance management & 360 feedback	●●○	●●●	Keka PMS and 360 are more polished
Native ATS / recruitment	●○○	●●●	Keka Hire native; greytHR integrates with 3rd-party ATS
Pricing accessibility	●●●	●○○	greytHR free tier; Keka Foundation ₹9,999/mo + setup
Weekend / off-hours support	●●●	●○○	Keka: no telephonic support Fri 6PM–Mon 10AM (G2)
Multi-entity support (>500 employees)	●●●	●○○	Keka struggles with multi-entity, large employee counts

Plant these early — let the prospect draw their own conclusions

? “What happens when payroll has an error at 9 PM on a Friday?”

YOUR RESPONSE

Keka has no telephonic support Fri 6 PM to Mon 10 AM (G2 verified review). greytHR's support team is reachable at month-end crunch — the most critical moment for any payroll team.

? “Do you have any entities outside India — UAE, KSA, or Singapore?”

YOUR RESPONSE

Keka is India-built and India-deployed. greytHR is live in 7+ GCC countries with localized compliance. Any multi-country need is an instant greytHR win.

? “What's the total cost — including setup, add-ons, and minimum commitments?”

YOUR RESPONSE

Keka's Foundation starts at ₹9,999/month but gates onboarding workflows, exit management, and advanced permissions behind higher tiers + implementation fees. Plus a minimum headcount lock-in clause.

? “How does the platform handle a state-level statutory update — say a PT revision?”

YOUR RESPONSE

greytHR auto-updates compliance rules — no developer ticket, no release cycle wait. With Keka, structural statutory changes often require vendor-side config, exposing your HR team between notification and fix.

What Keka will say — and how to respond

KEKA SAYS

“Keka UI looks much more modern”

YOUR RESPONSE

Keka was designed when Indian SaaS prioritized design — and it shows. But HR teams at month 12 cite the same regret: the platform couldn't handle statutory changes without a release cycle. A beautiful dashboard that generates a compliance error is a liability, not an asset.

KEKA SAYS

“Keka goes live faster — 2 to 4 weeks”

YOUR RESPONSE

Fast implementation often means skipping thorough configuration. greytHR's onboarding is deliberate precisely because payroll accuracy and statutory setup require it. The backend support team carries that complexity — your HR team doesn't have to.

KEKA SAYS

“Keka pricing looks comparable”

YOUR RESPONSE

Foundation plan starts at ₹9,999/mo but onboarding, exit workflows, advanced permissions require the Strength or Growth tier plus implementation fees. Keka also locks in a minimum headcount at negotiated pricing. greytHR is transparent and modular from day one.

KEKA SAYS

“We heard greytHR UI is dated”

YOUR RESPONSE

That criticism was fair two years ago. The interface has been updated significantly — G2 and Capterra ESS reviews are consistently strong. More importantly: your CFO and compliance head aren't evaluating the UI. They're evaluating payroll accuracy and statutory risk.

Different buyer, different conversation

H

HR Head

- Keka does look great in a demo — and your team will enjoy it day-to-day.
- But HR heads at month 12 tell us the same thing: UI didn't save them when a compliance rule changed.
- greytHR's statutory depth means you're never scrambling after a Budget update.

C

CFO / Finance

- Keka's Foundation plan looks affordable until you add up setup fees, higher tiers, and headcount lock-ins.
- greytHR's modular pricing means you pay only for what you use.
- Every compliance penalty avoided is direct savings — auto-updated rules mean no reactive fire-fighting.

I

IT Admin

- greytHR offers 40+ integrated tools and REST API for custom connections.
- Keka's integration library is thinner — users consistently flag missing Slack, limited connectors.
- India's first cloud HRMS since 2011 — 15 years of security architecture and uptime.

C

CEO / Founder

- If you're growing across India and the Middle East, you need one platform that follows you.
- greytHR is already live in UAE, KSA, Kuwait, Oman, Bahrain, Qatar, and Singapore.
- Keka is India-built and India-deployed. You'll stitch tools the moment you expand.

Know who you're talking to — and where greytHR fits best

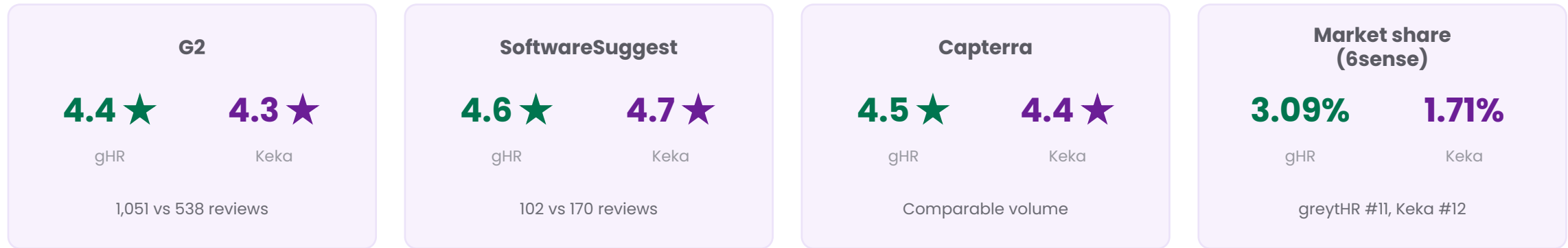
✓ greytHR wins here

- ✓ SMBs and mid-market, 20 to 5,000 employees, payroll-accuracy led
- ✓ Companies operating across India + GCC / MENA markets
- ✓ Finance-led buying decisions — compliance risk is non-negotiable
- ✓ Manufacturing, BFSI, retail — complex statutory and shift requirements
- ✓ Companies replacing legacy or manual payroll with a proven platform
- ✓ Businesses wanting transparent modular pricing with no surprise fees
- ✓ Multi-entity or group company structures requiring consolidated reporting

→ Keka tends to win here

- IT/ITES and startup environments that prize UI and employee experience
- HR-led buying decisions where the demo room matters most
- Single-entity India companies, 50 to 500 employees
- Companies wanting a native ATS + HCM in one bundled platform
- Teams moving from Zoho People looking for a modern step-up
- Organizations where fast go-live beats thorough configuration

What the data says — and what to acknowledge in the room



HONEST GAPS TO ACKNOWLEDGE

Transparency builds trust. Call these out before the prospect does.

- ⚠ UI is functional, not design-led — Keka will win the aesthetic conversation in demos with younger HR teams
- ⚠ Custom reporting beyond standard outputs requires extra effort — advanced analytics power users may hit friction
- ⚠ Some friction between the HR, Letters, Exit, and Expense modules — occasional manual reconciliation needed
- ⚠ No single point of contact for complex payroll queries at all tiers — escalation paths could be clearer
- ⚠ Mobile app admin capabilities are lighter than desktop — strongest for employee-facing self-service actions

REMEMBER THIS

1 Compliance first

greytHR's 25+ years of statutory depth is the defensible moat. Lead with it.

2 The Friday night test

Keka has no off-hours telephonic support. Plant this question in discovery.

3 GCC is yours

Any multi-country, especially India + UAE/KSA deal, is a greytHR win. Keka can't follow.

4 Reframe UI

Don't compete on aesthetics. Pivot to who the real buyer is — CFO and compliance own this decision.

5 Total cost of ownership

Keka's surface pricing hides setup fees, tier-gating, and minimum headcount lock-ins.